



Social Connection

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 For Everyone

KEY POINTS

- Staying connected to others creates feelings of belonging and being loved, cared for, and valued.
- Social connections are important to our mental and physical health.
- Being connected to others helps protect against serious illness and disease.
- People with stronger social bonds are more likely to live longer, healthier lives.



Overview

Social connection is the size and diversity of one's social network and roles, the functions these relationships serve, and their positive or negative qualities.

Social connectedness reflects the continuum of meeting social connection needs. It is the degree to which you have the number, quality, and variety of relationships that you want. It is when you feel like you belong and have the support and care that you need.



Supportive social connections can lead to longer and healthier lives.

Why it's important

Protection against chronic disease and serious illness

High-quality relationships can help people live longer, healthier lives. Social connection can help reduce the risk of chronic disease and serious illness, such as:

- Heart disease.
- Stroke.
- Dementia.
- Depression and anxiety.

Positive health benefits

Social connection can lead to longer life, better health, and well-being. It can improve:

- Our ability to manage stress, anxiety, and depression.
- Healthy eating habits and physical activity.
- Quality of sleep.

How it works

Creating social connections

People are social creatures by nature. Our relationships with family, friends, coworkers, and community members are important to our survival.

Stable and supportive relationships give us the support we need to cope with stressful life challenges.

People with healthy relationships are more likely to make healthy choices that lead to better mental and physical health.

Social connections give us:

- Emotional support: people we can turn to during good times and hard times.
- Physical support:
 - A ride to the doctor or grocery store.
 - Help with childcare on short notice.

Community connections

Communities that offer supportive connections are just as important. They can help create trust and resilience among community members in public places, such as:

- Neighborhoods.
- Schools.
- Places of worship.
- Workplaces.
- Parks and recreation centers.

Having safe access to public areas for people to connect encourages:

- Connections among people in the community.
- Less social isolation and loneliness.
- Community members to give back, further strengthening the bonds.

More on social connection

Visit and explore other topics on social connection.

[Improving Social Connectedness](#)

[Health Effects of Social Isolation and Loneliness](#)

[Promising Approaches to Promote Social Connection](#)

[Promoting Social Connection](#)

[CDC Social Connection Efforts](#)

SOURCES AND PAGE INFO

CONTENT SOURCE:

[National Center for Chronic Disease Prevention and Health Promotion \(NCCDPHP\)](#)

ABOUT THIS PAGE

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